

EC 9540: HUMAN COMPUTER INTERACTION
MINI GROUP PROJECT
LAB 01



YamuLK

**A Smart Travel Planning Platform for Sri Lankan
Domestic Travelers**

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Introduction

Traveling has become one of the most popular leisure activities among Sri Lankans. However, planning a trip often requires using multiple platforms to search for destinations, transportation, accommodation, weather conditions, and travel costs. This process can be time-consuming and confusing, especially for travelers who are unfamiliar with a destination.

YamuLK is a smart travel planning platform designed specifically for Sri Lankan domestic travelers. The platform aims to simplify the travel planning process by providing destination recommendations, itinerary planning, budget estimation, transportation options, weather updates, and nearby attractions in one place. Unlike general travel applications that mainly focus on international tourists, **YamuLK** is developed to meet the needs and preferences of local travelers within Sri Lanka.

The system focuses on improving the user experience by offering personalized travel recommendations based on the user's interests, available budget, travel duration, and preferred transportation method.

Description of the Problem

Planning a local trip in Sri Lanka is often inconvenient because travelers must gather information from several different sources. Users usually search through Google, YouTube, Facebook, travel blogs, and map applications separately before making travel decisions. This makes the planning process lengthy and inefficient.

Some common problems faced by Sri Lankan travelers include:

- Difficulty finding reliable information about local tourist destinations.
- Lack of a single platform that combines all travel-related information.
- Difficulty estimating the total travel budget.
- Poor itinerary planning for one-day or multi-day trips.
- Limited personalized recommendations based on user preferences.
- Difficulty finding suitable transportation options.
- Lack of updated weather information before traveling.
- Difficulty discovering nearby attractions and activities.

These issues often result in wasted time, poor travel experiences, and higher travel expenses. Therefore, there is a need for a user-friendly platform that helps local travelers efficiently plan their journeys.

Identification of the Target Users

YamuLK is designed for Sri Lankan residents who travel within Sri Lanka. The intended users are divided into several groups based on their travel behavior and requirements.

Group A: The Budget Backpackers / University Students (Age 18-25)

Characteristics:

- High tech-literacy.
- Prefer affordable transportation.
- Usually travel in groups.

Needs:

- Budget estimation.
- Low-cost accommodation.
- Bus and train information.
- Affordable travel destinations.

Group B: Family Travelers (Age 30-50)

Characteristics:

- Travel with children or elderly family members.
- Prioritize safety, comfort, and kid-friendly environments.
- Often travel by private vehicle or hired van.

Needs:

- Safe travel locations.
- Family accommodation.
- Nearby restaurants.
- Emergency facilities.

Group C: Adventure Travelers (Age 18-40)

Characteristics:

- Frequently explore new places.
- Interested in nature-based tourism.

Needs:

- Hiking information.
- Safety guidelines.
- Weather forecasts.
- Nearby attractions.

Group D: Corporate / Office Trip Planners (Age 25-45)

Characteristics:

- Traveling in large groups (15-40 people)
- Require bulk bookings.

Needs:

- Large villa/hotel bookings.
- Activity planning (team building).
- Budget estimation per head.

Group E: Pilgrimage / Elderly Travelers (Age 55+)

Characteristics:

- Lower tech-literacy.
- Require simple and highly accessible interfaces.

Needs:

- Proximity to religious sites (Anuradhapura, Kataragama, etc.)
- Wheelchair accessibility
- Nearby medical facilities.
- Easy-to-read itineraries.

Selected Requirement Gathering Methods

Questionnaire:

A questionnaire was selected as the primary requirement gathering method for this project. An online survey (via Google Forms) distributed through social media (WhatsApp, Facebook groups) to reach a wide demographic (Groups A, B & C) quickly.

Interviews:

Short, semi-structured interviews specifically targeted at Group E (Elderly travelers) and Group D (Office planners) to understand deeper pain points that a standard survey might miss.

Prepared Questionnaire

Google Form link: <https://forms.gle/9beqsznXsi7MTQdo7>

Section A – Personal Information

1. What is your age group?

- Under 18
- 18–25
- 26–35
- 36–45
- Above 45

2. What is your occupation?

- Student
- Government Employee
- Private Employee
- Self-employed
- Other

3. Which district do you currently live in?

Section B – Travel Behavior

4. How often do you travel within Sri Lanka?

- Weekly
- Monthly
- Every few months
- Once a year
- Rarely

5. Who do you usually travel with?

- Alone
- Friends
- Family
- Partner
- Tour group

6. What type of destinations do you usually prefer? (Select all that apply.)

- Beaches
- Waterfalls
- Mountains
- Historical places
- Wildlife parks
- Religious sites
- Camping locations
- Other

7. Which transportation method do you mostly use?

- Private vehicle
- Bus
- Train
- Taxi
- Three-wheeler
- Motorcycle

Section C – Travel Planning

8. How do you usually plan your trips?

- Google Search
- Social Media
- YouTube
- Friends or Family
- Travel websites
- Other

9. What difficulties do you usually face while planning a trip? (Select all that apply.)

- Finding destinations
- Planning routes
- Budget estimation
- Finding accommodation
- Weather information
- Transportation
- Time management
- Other

10. What is your average budget for a one-day trip?

- Less than LKR 2,000
- LKR 2,000–5,000
- LKR 5,001–10,000
- More than LKR 10,000

Section D – User Requirements

11. Which features would you like to have in a travel planning application? (Select all that apply.)

- Personalized destination recommendations
- Trip itinerary planner
- Budget calculator
- Route planner
- Weather updates
- Nearby attractions
- Hotel recommendations
- Restaurant suggestions
- Emergency contact information
- Travel checklist

12. How important is a budget estimation feature?

- Very Important
- Important
- Neutral
- Not Important

13. Would you use a mobile application that automatically recommends travel plans based on your interests and budget?

- Yes
- No
- Maybe

14. How easy should such an application be to use?

- Very Easy
- Easy
- Moderate
- Difficult

15. Do you have any additional suggestions or features you would like to see in YamuLK?